

Marina Ferro - Senior Product Designer

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Summary

Product designer with 14+ years of experience spanning UX/UI design, front-end engineering, and product strategy, with a strong bias to action (prototypes, not decks). Led cross-functional teams across fintech and developer tools, built design systems from zero, and turned messy workflows into shippable products.

Passionate about design craft, with a strong eye for detail, simplicity, and beauty. But also a systems thinker who cares about consistency, scalability, and feasibility. Proficient in Figma, React, Storybook, and TypeScript, because shipped is better than perfect.

Experience

Principal Product Designer - Nimbus Pay

Feb 2023 - Present | Remote

- Leading design for the core payments dashboard used by 40,000+ merchants
- **Cut checkout drop-off by 27%** by redesigning the onboarding flow and simplifying KYC steps
- Tech Stack: Figma, React, TypeScript, Storybook, Cursor

Senior Product Designer - Fintra

Jun 2019 - Jan 2023 | Remote

- Joined as first design hire, **built the design system from scratch**, adopted across 6 product squads
- Led the Open Banking initiative end-to-end, **shipping API integrations with 12 partner banks in under a year**
- Shipped a fraud-detection alerts redesign **from prototype to production in 3 weeks**, owning research, design, and front-end build (TypeScript, React, D3)
- Solo-designed and built the internal developer portal
- Tech Stack: Figma, React, TypeScript, D3, Astro

UX Lead - Bramble Studio

Sep 2015 - May 2019 | Barcelona, Spain

- **Grew the studio's design team from 2 to 12**, establishing hiring, onboarding, and critique practices
- **Defined product direction** for 5 client SaaS products, ensuring consistency across teams
- **Scaled a shared component library** adopted by 8 external agency partners

Design Lead - Forma Interactive

Mar 2012 - Aug 2015 | Madrid, Spain

- **Reduced project turnaround time by 30%** by integrating Agile ceremonies and cross-functional design sprints
- Elevated the **design practice** and implemented **sustainable growth strategies**
- Introduced **design critiques and pair design sessions**, improving team output and collaboration

Additional Experience

- **Product Designer** - Kelp Labs Jan 2011 - Feb 2012
- **Visual Designer** - Estudio Marabu Jun 2008 - Dec 2010
- **Junior Designer** - Punto y Coma Diseño Sep 2006 - May 2008

Projects

- **Fintra UI Kit** 2022 - Open-sourced the internal component library, **adopted by 3 external fintech startups**
- **The Open Banking Diaries** 2021 - Blog series on API-first design, **doubling newsletter signups**
- **Fraud Pattern Visualizer** 2020 - Internal tool for visualizing suspicious transaction clusters, **reducing investigation time by 40%**
- **Merchant Onboarding Wizard** 2019 - Redesigned multi-step KYC flow, **cutting support tickets by 35%**
- **SVG Icon Compressor** 2017 - Build-time optimizer for icon exports, averaging a **file size improvement of more than 45%**

Skills

- **Design Skills:** User Experience (UX), Interaction Design, Wireframing, User Research, Design Systems, Accessibility, Rapid Prototyping, Design Engineering, Design Tokens, UX Strategy, Usability Testing, Product Thinking
- **Design Tools:** Figma, Sketch, Miro, Penpot
- **Development:** React, TypeScript, Storybook, Astro, D3, HTML/CSS, Git

Public Speaking

- "Designing for Trust in Fintech" - Config Meetup (2022, Barcelona)
- "Open Banking, Open Design" - API Days (2021, remote)
- "Building Design Systems That Survive Contact with Reality" - UXSpain (2019, Valencia)
- "Prototyping at the Speed of Thought" - Design Tools Hackathon (2017, Madrid)

Community, Mentorship & Open Source

- **Fintra Design Guild** (2019 - 2023): Built and ran an internal cross-company **design community**, growing to **300+ members**
- **Mentor at ADPList** (2021 - Present): Supporting emerging designers in career growth, mentoring **15+ designers**
- **Open Source Contributions:** Maintainer of two open-source Figma plugins, frequent contributor to design-tooling projects, with more than **80 PRs merged over 40+ projects**